

Part 6: CARM Religions, Discipleship, and Biblical Response

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Parts of the deportation study series: Part 1 biblical passages; Part 2 supersessionism; Part 4 country statutes; Appendix A teacher comparison; **Part 6 (this document)** CARM comparative religion and biblical-response articles.

Cross-links to deportation study themes:

- Rom 13:1-7 - law of the land (Part 1)
- Lev 19:33-34 - sojourner vs nations of the land (Part 1 OT framework)
- Acts 4:19 - obey God when civil decree forbids gospel (Appendix A teachers)
- Num 31 - war judgment on Midian (this Part 6 bonus; distinct from ger/sojourner law)

SECTION A - WORLD RELIGIONS, GROUPS, CULTS, AND OCCULT

Baha'i

<https://carm.org/bahai> Author: CARM Date: 2020-06-16T18:10:40-06:00 1 min read

Baha'i is a recent religion begun in the 1800s by Bahá'u'lláh, who is, according to the Baha'i faith, the last great prophet. It teaches that all religions are valid and should be unified within a single worldwide community. God is unknowable and beyond assault. But, he has sent prophets throughout the centuries in order to communicate great truths that are completely and fully manifested within its own religious constructs.

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Buddhism

<https://carm.org/buddhism> Author: CARM Date: 2025-11-15T00:05:37.652+00:00 1 min read

Buddhism is a prominent Eastern religion founded in India about 500 years before Christ by a man named Siddhartha Gautama, who came to be known as the "Buddha" or "enlightened one." With roughly 500 million adherents, Buddhism is one of the world's largest religions. While by far most concentrated in Asia, Buddhism has been on the rise in the West since the 1960s, particularly in the Western United States. Not only does Buddhism differ from Christianity on individual claims such as who or what is God or what happens to us when we die, but Buddhism and Christianity also present entirely different views of the world that touch on every subject of importance.

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Eastern Orthodox Church

<https://carm.org/orthodox-church> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2026-08-04T22:43:16.353+00:00 4 min read

The Eastern Orthodox Church claims to be the original church founded by Jesus. It is old, full of tradition, and icons. It places a heavy emphasis on the church fathers and their priesthood. It has many interesting teachings, but, unfortunately, it is a mixture of faith and works for salvation. Is it truly Christian? No, it is not. The Eastern Orthodox Church teaches a false gospel and promotes idolatry in its adoration of Mary.

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Hinduism

<https://carm.org/hinduism> Author: CARM 5 min read

Hinduism is an Eastern religion founded in India thousands of years ago. It is the third-largest religion in the world, behind Christianity and Islam. It has no single founder but is a collection of various traditions and philosophies. Hinduism is a way of life for its followers, who believe in many gods and goddesses. With its doctrine of reincarnation and karma, Hindus seek to end their cycle of reincarnation by learning and telling they become part of the absolute soul. These articles on Hinduism should help you know what it is and how to evangelize those who adhere to it.

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Islam

<https://carm.org/islam> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2020-06-16T18:11:38-06:00 9 min read

Islam is one of the world's fastest-growing religions. But is it a religion of peace, violence, or a little of both? Muhammad taught that there is one God, no Trinity, that Jesus was not crucified (Surah 4:157), and that good works are needed for salvation. The Quran is a Muslim holy book containing a wide variety of topics. The Hadith are the deeds and sayings of Muhammad and are authoritative in the average Muslim's life. They contain volumes of material, some of which are hard to believe. All in all, Islam is a massive religion with millions of followers. Some consider it to be a Christian heresy, others a new, false religion. But, for Muslims, it is the revelation of their god.

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Jehovah's Witnesses

<https://carm.org/jehovahs-witnesses> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2025-12-13T20:19:18.267+00:00 6 min read

The Jehovah's Witnesses go door to door, distribute the Watchtower and Awake magazines, deny the Trinity, the deity of Christ, and deny his physical resurrection. Are they Christian or something else? Find out about their beliefs, history, as well as a Biblical Response to their unbiblical teachings.

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Kingdom of Jesus Christ

<https://carm.org/kingdom-of-jesus-christ> Author: CARM Date: 2020-06-16T18:14:58-06:00 1 min read

The Kingdom of Jesus Christ, The Name Above Every Name, is based in the Philippines and was started by Apollo Quiboloy, who claimed to be the "Appointed Son of God." This non-Christian cult denies the Trinity and says that Quiboloy is equal to Jesus. It also teaches that Jesus was a Savior of the Jews and Quiboloy is the Savior of the Gentiles. It teaches a serpent seed doctrine and that salvation is only attainable through acknowledging Quiboloy as the son of God.

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Mormonism (LDS)

<https://carm.org/mormonism> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2026-06-11T20:28:02.056+00:00 6 min read

Mormonism, also known as the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints (LDS), claims to be the restoration of the true gospel and a revelation of the true God. Find out about its teachings of men becoming gods, that we all preexisted before coming to earth, works added to salvation, temples, the Book of Mormon, and Joseph Smith, who claimed to have seen God the Father in contradiction to Scripture (1 Tim. 6:16). Is it Christian? No. It teaches a false god, a false Christ, and a false gospel.

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Oneness Pentecostal

<https://carm.org/oneness-pentecostal> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2026-08-04T20:34:48.436+00:00 2 min read

Oneness Pentecostalism is a movement of multiple churches (United Apostolic, United Pentecostal, etc.) that denies the Trinity and teaches that God is one person who took on different modes at different times. Typically, it is associated with hyper-charismatic experientialism, works righteousness, and the belief that baptism is required for salvation. It is not Christian.

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Roman Catholicism

<https://carm.org/roman-catholicism> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2026-07-30T21:34:24.978+00:00 9 min read

Roman Catholicism claims authority from Christ, apostolic succession, the priesthood, and the sole right to interpret Scripture. Yet, it clearly teaches things not taught in Scripture. In fact, it contradicts Scripture regarding salvation and worshipping someone other than God. So, we have to ask: Is Roman Catholicism true Christianity? No, it is not. There are many articles here, organized by category. They are well documented by Catholic Resources and compared with Scripture.

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Seventh Day Adventism

<https://carm.org/seventh-day-adventism> Author: CARM Date: 2026-06-30T22:35:27.438+00:00 1 min read

The Seventh-day Adventist church is a controversial organization. With its founding prophetess, Ellen G. White, they teach that the proper day of worship is Saturday, Jesus is Michael the Archangel, ultimately Satan will bear all of our sins, when a person dies he does not exist anymore, hell is not eternal, and more. They emphasize dietary laws and what many consider to be legalism, especially since they teach it is possible to lose salvation. Some consider it a cult and others do not. Nevertheless, it is an organization that needs to be examined.

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Wicca

<https://carm.org/wicca> Author: CARM 5 min read

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Christian Science

<https://carm.org/christian-science> Author: CARM Date: 2020-10-13T17:32:41-06:00 1 min read

Christian Science, founded by Mary Baker Eddy, is a non-Christian cult that emphasises Eastern mystical type theology of spiritual healing through the right understanding of their idea of god. Their god is the Universal Principle, an impersonal and all-good principle. Jesus manifested the 'Christ consciousness' and truth is what is revealed in the Bible and Science and Health. in Christian Science, Jesus was not the Christ and did not die. The Holy Spirit is 'divine science' and there is no devil and no such thing as sin.

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Amish

<https://carm.org/amish> Author: CARM Date: 2020-10-12T16:59:44-06:00 1 min read

The Amish are descended from the German Anabaptists. They live primarily in Pennsylvania and number more than 160,000. They require baptism, adherents to their customs, and can marry only within the Amish community. Those Amish who grow up within the community and do not adhere to their customs are shunned.

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Black Hebrew Israelites

<https://carm.org/black-hebrew-israelites> Author: Ryan Turner Date: 2011-07-11T14:06:47-06:00
23 min read

A profile on the Black Hebrew Israelite movement:

Founder: Various leaders for different sects. There is no primary leader today. First started in the United States before the Civil War.

Headquarters: Various major cities across the United States with state chapters. There does not appear to be a central headquarter of leadership for the movement.

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Kabbalah

<https://carm.org/kabbalah> Author: Matt Slick 4 min read

by Matt Slick | Apr 10, 2010 | Kabbalah Jewish, Minor Groups & Issues

Kabbalah is a mystical movement within Judaism that examines God and creation. It is developed from ancient texts like the Zohar, the Torah, and the Tree of Life. It focuses on spiritual transformation, connecting with the divine being, and determining hidden truths...

by Matt Slick | Dec 8, 2008 | Kabbalah Jewish, Minor Groups & Issues

Related links (from page)

- [Matt Slick](#)
- [Kabbalah Jewish](#)
- [Minor Groups & Issues](#)

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Open Theism

<https://carm.org/open-theism> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2010-04-10T13:01:13-06:00 3 min read

Open Theism, an introduction to what it teaches about God, people, knowledge, and truth. It is a dangerous and false teaching.

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- [Ezekiel 20:21-22, "I resolved to pour out My wrath...but I withdrew My hand..."](#)
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Open Theism sub-articles on CARM (50 fetched)

Article	Preview excerpt
1 Chronicle s 21:15, the Lord saw and was sorry over the calamity	December 08, 2008 2 min read Open theists use 1 Chron. 21:15 to support the idea that God's knowledge of the future is incomplete, and growing. But, the verse doesn't work for them when it is examined. "And God sent an angel to Jerusalem to destroy it; but as he was about to destroy it, the Lord saw and was sorry over the calamity, and said to the destroying angel, "It is enough; now relax your hand." And the angel of the Lord was standing by the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite," (1 Chron. 21:15). This verse is admittedly a difficult one to analyze. David was moved to number the people of Israel, and in so doing he sinned against God. Because of what he did, the Lord gave David three options of how God's judgment for this sin would fall on Israel. David chose to fall into the hands of the Lord, so God sent a pestilence upon Israel, and 70,000 people died (1 Chron. 21:14). Then, "...God sent an angel to Jerusalem to destroy it; but as he was about to destroy it, the Lord saw and was sorry over the calamity, and said to the destroying angel, 'It is enough; now relax your hand,'" (1 Chron. 21:15). There doesn't seem to be any reason to delay such an intercession, a lesson to be...
1 Kings 22: 20-22, "How will you entice Ahab?"	December 08, 2008 2 min read "And the Lord said, 'Who will entice Ahab to go up and fall at Ramoth-Gilead?' And one said this while another said that. 21 "Then a spirit came forward and stood before the Lord and said, 'I will entice him.' 22 "And the Lord said to him, 'How?' And he said, 'I will go out and be a deceiving spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.' Then He said, 'You are to entice him and also prevail. Go and do so,'" (1 Kings 22:20-22). Open theists like to say that God was ignorant of how the spirit would go and entice Ahab. But this is not necessarily so since God could simply have been asking this spirit so that it would publically say what it would do. God, as King in His spiritual kingdom, requires obedience of His subjects. God, like a king, inquires. In this case, it

	was not so God could learn, but that the truth of the spirit's intent could be made public. Contextually, Micaiah is relating a vision to Jehoshaphat, and it is in this vision that God asks the spirit what it will do. This is not necessarily literal as if God had to learn something.
<u>1 Samuel 15:10-11, "I regret that I have made Saul king..."</u>	December 08, 2008 1 min read "Then the word of the Lord came to Samuel, saying, 11 "I regret that I have made Saul king, for he has turned back from following Me, and has not carried out My commands." And Samuel was distressed and cried out to the Lord all night," (1 Samuel 15:10-11). This is an example of anthropomorphic expression where God speaks in human terms in human ways, often working through people, in time, and conditioning his comments contextually, relative to the time and situation of the people. God expresses emotion over the sin of people, such as anger (Deut. 9:8), regret (1 Sam. 15:11), sorrow (1 Chron. 21:15), and pity (Judges 2:18). God is merely displaying proper emotions at the proper time even though He knew from eternity that people would sin. Analogy: I knew my children would sin and grieve me before they were born, but that does not mean I did not know or was surprised by their rebellion when it happened, nor does it mean that I can't express regret. Furthermore, God is working relative to us; that is, He is working in our time frame and is expressing human-like emotions after seeing what people have done in their sinfulness. This is natural and is to b...
<u>1 Samuel 2:29-30, "...I did indeed say...but now the Lord declares..."</u>	December 08, 2008 2 min read "Why do you kick at My sacrifice and at My offering which I have commanded in My dwelling, and honor your sons above Me, by making yourselves fat with the choicest of every offering of My people Israel?" 30 "Therefore the LORD God of Israel declares, 'I did indeed say that your house and the house of your father should walk before Me forever'; but now the LORD declares, 'Far be it from Me - those who honor Me I will honor, and those who despise Me will be lightly esteemed,'" (1 Samuel 2:29-30). These verses demonstrate how God works and communicates in our time frame. There is no reason here to deny God's omniscience. Cannot God know exactly what the future will be (since it is His nature to be all-knowing) and yet allow us the freedom to be able to make choices? I see no reason why not. Our choices would be known by God ahead of time. God's knowledge doesn't restrict our ability to make such choices any more than me knowing that my daughter will choose to eat ice cream over broccoli means that my knowing it denies her the freedom to make a choice when it is time for her to choose which to eat. Here in 1 Samuel 2:29-30, there is no reason to deny that...
<u>2 Chronicle s 32:31, God tested him to know what was in his heart.</u>	December 08, 2008 1 min read "And even in the matter of the envoys of the rulers of Babylon, who sent to him to inquire of the wonder that had happened in the land, God left him alone only to test him, that He might know all that was in his heart," (2 Chron. 32:31) In 2 Chron. 32:31, Hezekiah was prospering and God "left him alone only to test him, that He might know all that was in his heart." This verse, however, cannot be claimed by open theists to show that God learns. The verse says that God tested him to know all that was in his heart. Even in open theism, God knows the present exhaustively. So, how could it be that God would test Hezekiah to see what was in his heart when God knows all present things exhaustively and could just look into his heart to see what was there? Obviously, there is more going on here than meets the eye. God routinely tests people, not so He will learn what they will actually do because God knows all things (1 John 3:20). Instead, it is usually for the strengthening and purification of the faith of God's people (or an individual) so they might learn and grow through the test. Furthermore, God speaks to them in discovery terms so they might hear and...
<u>2 Kings 20:1-6, "You shall die and not live... I will add 15 years to your life."</u>	December 08, 2008 3 min read "In those days Hezekiah became mortally ill. And Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz came to him and said to him, Thus says the Lord, 'Set your house in order, for you shall die and not live.'" 2 Then he turned his face to the wall, and prayed to the Lord, saying, 3 "Remember now, O Lord, I beseech Thee, how I have walked before Thee in truth and with a whole heart, and have done what is good in Thy sight." And Hezekiah wept bitterly. 4 And it came about before Isaiah had gone out of the middle court, that the word of the Lord came to him, saying, 5 "Return and say to Hezekiah the leader of My people, 'Thus says the Lord, the God of your father David, "I have heard your prayer, I have seen your tears; behold, I will heal you. On the third day, you shall go up to the house of the Lord. 6 "And I will add fifteen years to your life, and I will deliver you and this city from the hand of the king of Assyria, and I will defend this city for My own sake and for My servant David's sake,""' (2 Kings 20:1-6). Here we see an example of God listening to the prayer of someone and then apparently changing His mind about a course of action that He said He would do. D...
<u>Amos 7:1-6, "The Lord changed His</u>	December 08, 2008 3 min read "Thus the Lord God showed me, and behold, He was forming a locust-swarm when the spring crop began to sprout. And behold, the spring crop was after the king's mowing. 2 And it came about, when it had finished eating the vegetation of the land, that I said, "Lord God, please pardon! How can Jacob stand, for he is small?" 3 The

<u>mind about this"</u>	Lord changed His mind about this. "It shall not be," said the Lord. 4Thus the Lord God showed me, and behold, the Lord God was calling to contend with them by fire, and it consumed the great deep and began to consume the farm land. Then I said, 5"Lord God, please stop! How can Jacob stand, for he is small?" 6 The Lord changed His mind about this. "This too shall not be," said the Lord God," (Amos 7:1-6). In Amos 7:3, the KJV, ASV, and RSV say, "The Lord repented." The NKJV, NIV, and ESV say, "The Lord relented." The NASB says "The Lord changed His mind." In Amos 7:6, "KJV, ASV, RSV, "The Lord repented." NIV, NKJV, ESV "Relented," NASB, "The Lord changed His mind."
<u>Anthropomorphism: God relates to us in human terms</u>	December 08, 2008 5 min read Anthropomorphism comes from two Greek words: anthropos (man) and morphe (form). Therefore, an anthropomorphism is when God appears to us or manifests Himself to us in human form or even attributes to Himself human characteristics. We see this all over the Bible - and rightly so. After all, we cannot ascend to where God is, but He can descend to where we are. Following are a few verses from the Bible that ascribe to God, human actions, attributes, and emotions. Remember, God works with us in our time frame. He has endured not only eternity but also human history as He moves through it and through and with people to bring about His sovereign will and purpose. Should we then assume that God would not relate to us in terms familiar to our own actions? And should we not also assume that in so doing God will present aspects of Himself to us that would be paradoxical? Take for example the fact that God is all-powerful (Jer. 32:17,27), yet He rests (Gen. 2:2). We see that God is in all places (Psalm 139:7-12), yet He asks Adam, "Where are you?" (Gen. 3:9). We see that God knows all things (1 John 3:20). Yet, we see that God says, "Now I know that you fear G...
<u>Can the god of open theism make mistakes?</u>	December 09, 2008 5 min read Open theism, also known as the Open view, teaches that God learns, that He gains knowledge as He discovers what people decide to do. They teach this because they believe that God does not know the future. Therefore God learns what happens as things occur. Unfortunately, the logical problem is that God could then make mistakes. Just as we make mistakes because we do not know what will happen, so too the God of open theism can also error. He could make a prediction that could fail. He might expect someone to repent who does not. He might believe that one thing will happen and yet it fails to occur. These would be mistakes on God's part. Open theists, however, do not like the idea of saying that the God of the universe makes mistakes either in His sovereign predictions or in His expectations. But the fact is, due to the doctrinal makeup of the open theist's position, God cannot know future events and therefore cannot absolutely predict all events with 100% assurance. At best, the open theist could say that God is an extremely efficient predictor in that He knows people and phenomena so well that He can extrapolate what the outcome of various situations ...
<u>Can you trust the God of Open Theism?</u>	December 09, 2008 3 min read In Open Theism, God does not exhaustively know the future. He also makes mistakes, learns, and has regrets because of His ignorance of future events. The open theist says that God does not know future free will choices of people because He either chooses to not know the future or because the future is unknowable. If this is so, then I cannot help but ask whether or not the God of open theism can be trusted. After all, God doesn't know the future, can make mistakes, and actually changes His mind. Let's say that you're an open theist, and you have a very important and biblical need that you want to pray about. Let's further say that you have just learned that God can make mistakes, that He must adapt to human choices, and that He does not know the future exhaustively. Would you feel confident in approaching God if you believed He could goof, that He would have to go through a learning curve, and that He did not know the future choices of people? In my opinion, the open theist has little grounds for confidence. Now, I admit right away that I am exaggerating the forthcoming prayer a bit, but it is to make a point; namely, that open theism undermines trust...
<u>Deuteronomy 13:1-3, "...God is testing you to find out if you love the Lord..."</u>	December 08, 2008 2 min read "If a prophet or a dreamer of dreams arises among you and gives you a sign or a wonder, 2and the sign or the wonder comes true, concerning which he spoke to you, saying, 'Let us go after other gods (whom you have not known) and let us serve them,' 3you shall not listen to the words of that prophet or that dreamer of dreams; for the Lord your God is testing you to find out if you love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul," (Deut. 13:1-3). This is an example of a testing situation. God routinely tests people-not so that God will learn what they will actually do, because God knows all things (1 John 3:20). Instead, it is for the strengthening and purification of the faith of God's people so they might learn to depend on Him more. People grow through tests. Furthermore, God speaks to them in discovery terms so that they might hear and know that God "now will use them" according to His purpose. Testing verses are also related to God's anthropomorphic expression where God speaks in human terms in human ways as He reveals Himself to and through people. If we were to look at this from the perspective of open theism, we have a problem....

<u>Deuteronomy 8:2, "God tests people to know what is in their hearts"</u>	December 08, 2008 2 min read Open Theists often appeal to passages where God tests people as alleged proof of their position. Take a common example: "And you shall remember all the way which the Lord your God has led you in the wilderness these forty years, that He might humble you, testing you, to know what was in your heart, whether you would keep His commandments or not," (Deut. 8:2). Basically, the open theist position on this verse is that since God does not know the future, He tests people to figure out what was in their hearts because (according to the open theist's argument) He doesn't know and has to figure it out. But there is a problem here because, even in open theism, God knows all present things exhaustively. If God was going to test people to see what was in their hearts, does that mean God did not know what was already there? That would make no sense, even in open theism. If the open theist says that God's test was to discover what would be in their hearts later, then I point them back to the text which does not speak that way. It speaks of the past.
<u>Deuteronomy 9:13-14, "Let me alone that I may destroy them."</u>	December 09, 2008 7 min read Open Theists often use Moses' effective intercession for Israel as "proof" that God is learning and does not know what will happen in the future or what people will say or do. In this view, God apparently relents because Moses was able to surprise God with arguments He did anticipate and thus help God see a new perspective He had not yet considered and thus change His mind. One such passage reads: "The Lord spoke further to me, saying, 'I have seen this people, and indeed, it is a stubborn people. 14'Let Me alone, that I may destroy them and blot out their name from under heaven; and I will make of you a nation mightier and greater than they,'" (Deuteronomy 9:13-14). This verse is a review statement made by Moses before Israel. Contextually, Moses was recounting how God had almost destroyed them, but through Moses' intercession, the Lord relented. Moses is referring to the events in the book of Exodus.
<u>Deuteronomy 9:18-20, "...but the Lord listened to me that time also..."</u>	December 08, 2008 7 min read When Moses intercedes for Israel and God spares them, does that prove that God doesn't know the future? Open Theists seem to think so. Note how they handle the following verse: "And I fell down before the Lord, as at the first, forty days and nights; I neither ate bread nor drank water, because of all your sin which you had committed in doing what was evil in the sight of the Lord to provoke Him to anger. 19For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure with which the Lord was wrathful against you in order to destroy you, but the Lord listened to me that time also. 20And the Lord was angry enough with Aaron to destroy him; so I also prayed for Aaron at the same time," (Deuteronomy 9:18-20). Deut. 9:18-20 is a recap of the Exodus account. Moses is simply reminding the people of Israel about their past sin and how the Lord was merciful to them. The account where Moses intercedes for Israel first appears in Exodus. For convenience sake, I have reproduced the comments on Exodus 32:12-14 here which cover the same subject.
<u>Does God choose to not know the future free-will choices of human creatures?</u>	December 09, 2008 4 min read There are differing views among open theists about the nature of the future and whether or not God can know it. Some Open Theists maintain that God can only know that which is knowable and that he cannot know, for example, a round square. (An open theist once raised this point to me. But, I do not see this as a very good point at all because there is no such thing as a round square. It is not logically possible to exist and his point is a self-defeating example.) Some say that the future is knowable, but that God chooses not to know the free will choices of human creatures. Others state that the future is not knowable because it has not yet occurred and it is not knowable, even by God. Nevertheless, this paper will address the premise that God chooses to not know the future free-will choices of human creatures to see if it is a defensible position. If God chooses to not know certain future events, then that means that the future is knowable, that God is not restricted by time (otherwise He could not know the future), and that God simply is able to choose to not know the future free will choices. Let's look at this logically. The above examination sh...
<u>Exodus 13:17, "...Lest the people change their minds..."</u>	December 08, 2008 1 min read "Now it came about when Pharaoh had let the people go, that God did not lead them by the way of the land of the Philistines, even though it was near; for God said, 'Lest the people change their minds when they see war, and they return to Egypt,'" (Exodus 13:17). This verse, like Exodus 4:9, is a conditional statement where God knows the future and states what will happen if different choices are made, i.e., "If you do this, then this will happen; if you do that, that will happen." Since the Lord is all-knowing, He knows what will happen if certain conditions occur. In Exodus 13:17, God was stating that He knew what would happen to the people's faith if they were to face the Philistines and war. So, He led them in a different direction. This demonstrates that God knows the future. He knows what will happen under different circumstances. If, as Open Theism states, God does not exhaustively know the future, but only the present, then how would he know what the Jews would actually do when facing the Philistines? At best, God could only guess. Is this what we have here? Is God guessing? Is He hoping for the best by trying to avoid war with the Philistines...

<u>Exodus 16:4, "...that I may test them, whether or not they will walk in My instruction."</u>	December 08, 2008 1 min read "Then the Lord said to Moses, 'Behold, I will rain bread from heaven for you; and the people shall go out and gather a day's portion every day, that I may test them, whether or not they will walk in My instruction,'" (Exodus 16:4). Is God ignorant of what the outcome will be in a given test? The open theists would say yes, but this cannot be since God knows all things (1 John 3:20). This testing is not so God will learn. Instead, it is for the strengthening and purification of the faith of God's people, so they might learn and grow through trials. The testing here is the training they will need for the future. The word for "test" here is nacah. It means to "test, try, prove, tempt, assay, put to the proof or test." ¹ The word does cover the aspect of proving, putting to the test, which is what God was doing to the Israelites. It does not mean that God had to learn something new.
<u>Exodus 32:14, "...the Lord changed His mind..." and Open Theism</u>	December 08, 2008 5 min read "So the Lord changed His mind about the harm which He said He would do to His people," (Exodus 32:14, NASB). Different Bible's translate this verse differently. The NASB says, "the Lord changed His mind." The NIV and NKJV say "The Lord relented." The KJV, RSV, and the 1901 ASV say, "The Lord repented." The Hebrew word at issue here is relent/repent is נָחַם (nacham). There are 108 occurrences in the Old Testament. The KJV translates it as "comfort" 57 times, "repent" 41 times, "comforter" nine times, and "ease" once. (Strong, James. The Exhaustive Concordance of the Bible: Showing Every Word of the Test of the Common English Version of the Canonical Books, and Every Occurrence of Each Word in Regular Order. electronic ed., H5162. Ontario: Woodside Bible Fellowship., 1996.) The issue, of course, is whether or not God actually goes through a process of changing His mind due to learning something, as the open theists would maintain. But, is God actually reacting to knew "Turn from Thy burning anger and change Thy mind about doing harm to Thy people. 13'Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, Thy servants to whom Thou didst swear by Thyself, and didst say t...
<u>Exodus 4:9, "...if they will not believe..."</u>	December 08, 2008 2 min read "But it shall be that if they will not believe even these two signs or heed what you say, then you shall take some water from the Nile and pour it on the dry ground; and the water which you take from the Nile will become blood on the dry ground," (Exodus 4:9). This verse does not mean that God doesn't know what will happen. First of all, because God knows all things (1 John 3:20), He can tell us what will happen in the future if different choices are made by people in the present. Therefore, if God says "If you do this, then this will happen, and if you do that will happen," this is not showing uncertainty. On the contrary, it is showing that God absolutely knows what will happen given different options. IF God did not have exhaustive foreknowledge of the future (both actual and potential), then how would it be possible to tell us what would happen? Second, God works within the time realm of people. This is a fact since we see in the Bible how God tells people what will happen to them later in life. These prophecies do not come true until later, until after time has passed. Therefore, God, in our perspective, waits and accomplishes His desires someti...
<u>Ezekiel 12:1-3, "Perhaps they will understand..."</u>	December 08, 2008 1 min read "Then the word of the Lord came to me saying, 2"Son of man, you live in the midst of the rebellious house, who have eyes to see but do not see, ears to hear but do not hear; for they are a rebellious house. 3"Therefore, son of man, prepare for yourself baggage for exile and go into exile by day in their sight; even go into exile from your place to another place in their sight. Perhaps they will understand though they are a rebellious house," (Ezek. 12:1-3). God is not showing ignorance of the future. He is displaying how He works through our time frame. When God states "Perhaps they will understand..." it does not mean He is ignorant of the future. It means God is communicating to us in a manner that we can understand. In this case, God is beginning His judicial examination (Frame, John, No Other God: A Response to Open Theism, Phillipsburg, NJ: Presbyterian and Reformed Publishing, 2001, p. 194-95.)by which He might rightfully bring judgment against the lawbreakers. It is not an arbitrary judgment that is coming, but one that is fairly administered after their rebellion has taken full force. It is an anthropomorphic expression where God uses human te...
<u>Ezekiel 20:21-22, "I resolved to pour out My wrath... but I withdrew My hand..."</u>	December 08, 2008 2 min read "But the children rebelled against Me; they did not walk in My statutes, nor were they careful to observe My ordinances, by which, if a man observes them, he will live; they profaned My Sabbaths. So I resolved to pour out My wrath on them, to accomplish My anger against them in the wilderness. 22"But I withdrew My hand and acted for the sake of My name, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations in whose sight I had brought them out" (Ezek. 20:21-22). God speaks His comments contextually in human terms in human conditioning, relative to the time and situation of the people. God expresses emotion over the sin of people, emotions such as anger (Deut. 9:8), regret (1 Sam. 15:11), sorrow (1 Chron. 21:15), and pity (Judges 2:18). Likewise, God expresses to His people emotions in response to their sin. This is for their benefit, as it enables God's people to understand and relate to Him. This is why God lets people know that He gets

	angry and then stays His hand from carrying out His judgment. The people need to know that they had a "close call" because they need to know God does not tolerate sin and that He will deal with it. In open thei...
Ezekiel 22: 29-31, " . . I searched for a man who should build up the wall . . . "	December 08, 2008 1 min read "The people of the land have practiced oppression and committed robbery, and they have wronged the poor and needy and have oppressed the sojourner without justice. 30"And I searched for a man among them who should build up the wall and stand in the gap before Me for the land, that I should not destroy it; but I found no one. 31"Thus I have poured out My indignation on them; I have consumed them with the fire of My wrath; their way I have brought upon their heads," declares the Lord God" (Ezek. 22:29-31). Open theism teaches that God knows all the present exhaustively, including the hearts of all people. If this is so, then why would God have to search for someone who would build the wall? Wouldn't God simply know who would do it? Of course, He would. Therefore, this verse isn't speaking about God not knowing something. God doesn't have to search what He already knows in the present exhaustively. Instead, God is simply speaking in human terms about justifying H/open-theism/is wrath upon the people.
Ezekiel 33: 13-15, "God changes His mind about death and life."	December 08, 2008 2 min read Ezekiel 33:13-15, "God changes His mind about death and life." "When I say to the righteous he will surely live, and he so trusts in his righteousness that he commits iniquity, none of his righteous deeds will be remembered; but in that same iniquity of his which he has committed he will die. 14"But when I say to the wicked, 'You will surely die,' and he turns from his sin and practices justice and righteousness, 15if a wicked man restores a pledge, pays back what he has taken by robbery, walks by the statutes which ensure life without committing iniquity, he will surely live; he shall not die. 16"None of his sins that he has committed will be remembered against him. He has practiced justice and righteousness; he will surely live," (Ezekiel 33:13-16). When God states "If you do this, then this will happen; if you do that, that that will happen," it does not mean He is ignorant of the future. It means that God is revealing the results of what will happen as a result of our various choices. This absolute knowledge by God is possible because He knows all things, including the future and all its options. By contrast, this is not possible with the god of ...
Genesis 22: 12, "For now I know that you fear God" and Open Theism	December 08, 2008 6 min read "And he said, 'Do not stretch out your hand against the lad, and do nothing to him; for now I know that you fear God, since you have not withheld your son, your only son, from Me,'" (Gen. 22:12). Open Theists say that we should look at the Bible and take verses like Gen. 22:12 strictly for what they say. Of course, there are times when we should do that and others when we should not. Nevertheless, the Open Theists conclude that God had to learn what Abraham would do; God had to learn. But if we just assume that God had to learn, then other problems arise when we examine this text in that light. Let's take a look. If God did not know that Abraham was going to slay Isaac or not, then did God know if Abraham was going to take Isaac to the hill, tell Isaac to carry the wood, and a host of other decisions that had to be made in order for it all to work out. That is a lot of hopeful desires of God, hoping that Abraham will do what God ultimately wants him to do.
Genesis 6: 6, "And the Lord was sorry He had made man on the earth . . . "	December 08, 2008 1 min read "And the Lord was sorry that He had made man on the earth, and He was grieved in His heart," (Gen. 6:6, NASB). The above verse is not a problem for Classical Christian Theism, nor is it a proof text for Open Theism. The verse simply tells us that the Lord was grieved and had sorrow in His heart for making man. Why? Because mankind had fallen into great sin, and this grieved the Lord. Does it mean that God didn't know mankind would fall and become sinful? Of course not. God knew that they would become sinners and also be grieved when it happens. Let me illustrate. I have children. I love them and provide for them, but they have grieved me in their various sins - as any child will do to his parents. I knew they would grieve me when they were born because I know they are sinners by nature. This doesn't mean I was surprised and didn't know they would rebel when it happened. Quite the contrary; knowing they would sin didn't mean I wasn't grieved when their rebellion and sin was finally manifested.
If God knows our free will choice, do we still have free will?	August 10, 2017 6 min read I've always been puzzled by the notion held by some people that if God knows what we are going to choose in the future, then we don't really have free will. They say that if God knows we are going to make a certain "free will" choice, then when it is time for us to make that choice because God knows what we are going to choose, we are not really free to make a different choice and God's foreknowledge means we cannot have free will. Quite honestly, I do not see this as being a problem at all. Let's work with the idea that we are free-will creatures and that God knows all things, even our future choices. Furthermore, let's define free will in the Open Theist sense as the ability to make equal choices between options, regardless of a person's sinful nature. (This is called Libertarian free will, that a person is equally able to make choices between options independent of pressures or constraints from external or internal causes. Compatibilist

	free will holds that a person can choose only that which is consistent with his nature. Therefore, for example, a person who is a slave to sin (Rom. 6:14-20) and cannot understand spiritual things (1 Cor. 2:14) would...
Isaiah 5:3-7, God expected good grapes but received worthless ones	December 09, 2008 2 min read Isaiah 5:3-7 is a perfect example of anthropomorphism found in a parable which is in the form of a song, where God speaks in human terms. God expects one thing and gets another. Is this an example of God being surprised and learning? No, it is not. God knows all things (1 John 3:20). But, he speaks in such a way that we can relate to. Such is the case here. "And now, O inhabitants of Jerusalem and men of Judah, judge between Me and My vineyard. 4 "What more was there to do for My vineyard that I have not done in it? Why, when I expected it to produce good grapes did it produce worthless ones? 5 "So now let Me tell you what I am going to do to My vineyard: I will remove its hedge and it will be consumed; I will break down its wall and it will become trampled ground. 6 "And I will lay it waste; it will not be pruned or hoed, but briars and thorns will come up. I will also charge the clouds to rain no rain on it." 7 For the vineyard of the Lord of hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah His delightful plant. Thus He looked for justice, but behold, bloodshed; for righteousness, but behold, a cry of distress," (Isaiah 5:3-7). This section of sc...
Jer. 3:19-20, "...so you have dealt treacherously with Me..."	December 09, 2008 1 min read "Then I said, 'How I would set you among My sons, and give you a pleasant land, the most beautiful inheritance of the nations!' And I said, 'You shall call Me, My Father, and not turn away from following Me.' 20"Surely, as a woman treacherously departs from her lover, so you have dealt treacherously with Me, O house of Israel," declares the Lord," (Jer. 3:19-20). These verses are sometimes used by open theists to demonstrate that God is caught off guard, even surprised by the turn of events. I am not sure why they would use these verses, but God is only stating the obvious, and it is not a demonstration of surprise.
Jeremiah 18:7-11, "I will relent concerning the calamity I planned to bring."	December 09, 2008 2 min read Interestingly enough, the open theists often refer to this section of scripture to prove that God changes His mind. But, if anything, these verses work against the open theist. "At one moment I might speak concerning a nation or concerning a kingdom to uproot, to pull down, or to destroy it; 8if that nation against which I have spoken turns from its evil, I will relent concerning the calamity I planned to bring on it. 9Or at another moment I might speak concerning a nation or concerning a kingdom to build up or to plant it; 10if it does evil in My sight by not obeying My voice, then I will think better of the good with which I had promised to bless it. 11"So now then, speak to the men of Judah and against the inhabitants of Jerusalem saying, 'Thus says the Lord, "Behold, I am fashioning calamity against you and devising a plan against you. Oh turn back, each of you from his evil way, and reform your ways and your deeds" (Jer. 18:7-11). God works covenantally. In other words, He establishes covenants with people and ratifies them with signs. Covenants are packs and agreements between two or more parties. These covenants have stipulations and condition...
Jeremiah 19:5, "Nor did it ever enter My mind."	December 09, 2008 1 min read "and have built the high places of Baal to burn their sons in the fire as burnt offerings to Baal, a thing which I never commanded or spoke of, nor did it ever enter My mind," (Jer. 19:5). This verse is answered the same way as Jer. 7:31. ex Is the Lord actually saying He did not think of something? Even in open theism, God knows all things actual as well as potential. That means God can know all things in the present tense as well as all possibilities of things that could exist. Certainly, God who knew the past sins of Israel would have thought about them doing such sin-as horrible as it was. So, it doesn't make sense to interpret this as God admitting that He never thought of something.
Jeremiah 26:19, "...the Lord changed His mind..."	December 09, 2008 2 min read "Did Hezekiah king of Judah and all Judah put him to death? Did he not fear the Lord and entreat the favor of the Lord, and the Lord changed His mind about the misfortune which He had pronounced against them? But we are committing a great evil against ourselves," (Jer. 26:19). The Hebrew word for "changed His mind" is nacham. It also means "relented," and it "does not mean that God changed His mind but that He embarked on another course of action. The Hebrew word nacham suggests relief or comfort from a planned, undesirable course of action. God is not inflexible; He responds to individuals' needs, attitudes, and actions." (Walvoord, John F., and Roy B. Zuck, The Bible Knowledge Commentary, Wheaton, IL: Scripture Press Publications, 1985.) Different Bible translations render this verse differently. The NASB says, "changed His mind." The NIV and NKJV, say "relent." The KJV, RSV, and 1901 ASV say "repent." Either way, the Lord knows the future and states what will happen if different choices are made, i.e., "If you do this, then this will happen; if you do that, that that will happen." It does not mean that God is ignorant of the future and has to adapt...
Jeremiah 26:3, "Perhaps they will..."	December 09, 2008 1 min read "Perhaps they will listen and everyone will turn from his evil way, that I may repent of the calamity which I am planning to do to them because of the evil of their deeds," (Jer. 26:3). The Lord often speaks to us in our time reference so

<u>l listen an d everyone will turn f rom his evi l way."</u>	that what He wants to accomplish gets done. It is important to understand that God brings about certain changes in people by telling them that they will be punished if they continue in sin. They hear God's pronouncement, change their ways, and repent. God then "changes" from punishing them to blessing them. This does not mean that God did not know from all eternity that they would change their ways. It means that from all eternity God ordained the means by which they would change; namely, His pronouncement of judgment which would motivate them to change. It is this working in our time frame that is necessary for us, not God. The means God uses to bring change is often the appearance of options He gives us. As free creatures, He gives us the choice to change - knowing ahead of time what our choices will be should He warn us; thereby, bringing about change through His interaction with us. This is a better explanation ...
<u>Jeremiah 3: 6-7, I thou ght she wou ld return b ut she did not.</u>	December 09, 2008 2 min read "Then the Lord said to me in the days of Josiah the king, "Have you seen what faithless Israel did? She went up on every high hill and under every green tree, and she was a harlot there. 7" And I thought, 'After she has done all these things, she will return to Me'; but she did not return, and her treacherous sister Judah saw it," (Jer. 3:6-7). What we see here is an anthropomorphic expression (God using human terms, forms, and means) from God about Israel. God speaks to Israel as a husband speaks to his wife. John Frame sums it up beautifully: "In Jeremiah 3, God interacts with Israel as a husband with his unfaithful wife...this passage deals with God's relation to Israel in history, not his eternal decrees and eternal foreknowledge. The thrust of the passage is that recent history should have motivated the repentance of Israel and Judah, but in fact they continued their spiritual adultery. As their husband, God had hoped (this hope being an expression of his preceptive will) for something better." (Frame, John, No Other God: A Response to Open Theism, Phillipsburg, NJ: Presbyterian and Reformed Publishing, 2001, p. 196.)
<u>Jeremiah 3 2:35, "... nor had i t entered M y mind that they should do this"</u>	December 09, 2008 2 min read Jeremiah 32:35 is recounting of an earlier time of Judah's sinfulness. Both Israel and Judah had provoked God due to their sin of idolatry (Jer. 7:30-32; 19:5-6) and had refused the correction of God. Therefore, God delivered them into judgment (Jer. 32:36-41). It is in verse 35 that God said, "nor had it entered My mind." Let's take a look. "And they built the high places of Baal that are in the valley of Ben-Hinnom to cause their sons and their daughters to pass through the fire to Molech, which I had not commanded them nor had it entered My mind that they should do this abomination, to cause Judah to sin," (Jeremiah 32:35). Is the Lord actually saying that He did not think of something? Even in open theism, God knows all things actual as well as potential. That means God can know all things in the present tense, as well as all the possibilities of things that could exist. Certainly, God who knew the past sins of Israel would have thought about them doing such sin - as horrible as it was. So, it doesn't make sense to interpret this as God admitting that He had never thought of something.
<u>Jeremiah 3 8:17-18, 2 0, If you l isten to Go d, you will live. If no t, you will die</u>	December 09, 2008 2 min read Open theists often state that God displays ignorance of the future by telling people what will happen if they do one thing or another. They assert God doesn't know, and that is why He is laying out the options of what might possibly happen in the future. "Then Jeremiah said to Zedekiah, "Thus says the Lord God of hosts, the God of Israel, 'If you will indeed go out to the officers of the king of Babylon, then you will live, this city will not be burned with fire, and you and your household will survive. 18' But if you will not go out to the officers of the king of Babylon, then this city will be given over to the hand of the Chaldeans; and they will burn it with fire, and you yourself will not escape from their hand...20 But Jeremiah said, "They will not give you over. Please obey the Lord in what I am saying to you, that it may go well with you and you may live," (Jer. 38:17-18, 20). When God states "If you do this, then this will happen; if you do that, that that will happen," it does not mean that God is ignorant of the future. It means God is revealing the results of what will happen as a result of various choices. This absolute knowledge of God is ...
<u>Jeremiah 7: 31, "... it did not come into M y mind."</u>	December 09, 2008 1 min read "And they have built the high places of Topheth, which is in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to burn their sons and their daughters in the fire, which I did not command, and it did not come into My mind," (Jer. 7:31). Is the Lord actually saying that He did not think of something? Even in open theism, God knows all things actual as well as potential. That means God can know all things in the present tense as well as all possibilities of things that could exist. Certainly, God who knew the past sins of Israel would have thought about them doing such sin - as horrible as it was. So, it doesn't make sense to interpret this as God admitting that He never thought of something. Furthermore, the NASB, (The NASB has a marginal note of "heart.") NIV, RSV, 1901 ASV, translate this as "and it did not come into My mind," where the KJV and NKJV translate it as "and it did not come into my heart." What is interesting is that the LXX (The LXX, or Septuagint, is the Greek translation of the Hebrew Old Testament. It was translated by Jews

	around 200 B.C.) uses the Greek word kardia, "heart," instead of the Greek word for mind. Since we can conclude that God can conte...
Joel 2:13-14, "Who knows whether He will not turn and relent?"	December 09, 2008 2 min read "And rend your heart and not your garments. Now return to the Lord your God, for He is gracious and compassionate, slow to anger, abounding in lovingkindness, and relenting of evil. Who knows whether He will not turn and relent, 14 And leave a blessing behind Him, even a grain offering and a libation for the Lord your God?" (Joel 2:13-14). If we ask who knows whether God will turn and relent, the answer is simple. God knows. God knows His own heart and knows what He will do. We can see that God asks questions even though He already knows the answer to the question. God asking "Who knows whether He will not turn and relent?" does not mean He didn't know the answer. For example, Jesus asked who the Jews came for in the Garden of Gethsemane when the text clearly states that Jesus knew all things. John 18:3-5 says,
Jonah 1:2; 3:2, 10; 4:2, God relenting calamity.	December 09, 2008 2 min read "Arise, go to Nineveh the great city and cry against it, for their wickedness has come up before Me." 3:2, "Arise, go to Nineveh the great city and proclaim to it the proclamation which I am going to tell you." 3:10, "When God saw their deeds, that they turned from their wicked way, then God relented concerning the calamity which He had declared He would bring upon them. And He did not do it." 4:2 "He prayed to the LORD and said, "Please LORD, was not this what I said while I was still in my own country? Therefore, in order to forestall this, I fled to Tarshish, for I knew that You are a gracious and compassionate God, slow to anger and abundant in lovingkindness, and one who relents concerning calamity" (Jonah 1:2; 3:2; 4:2). God states in Jeremiah 18:8-9, "If that nation against which I have spoken turns from its evil, I will relent concerning the calamity I planned to bring on it. Or at another moment I might speak concerning a nation or concerning a kingdom to build up or to plant it." We see that the Lord has said He will not bring judgment if that nation turns from its sin. Nineveh did turn from its sin after Jonah gave them the warning from Go...
Judges 2:21-22, God tests Israel to see if they will obey.	December 09, 2008 1 min read Judges 2:21-22, God tests Israel to see if they will obey. "I also will no longer drive out before them any of the nations which Joshua left when he died, 22in order to test Israel by them, whether they will keep the way of the Lord to walk in it as their fathers did, or not," (Judges 2:21-22). God routinely tests people, but not so He will learn what they will actually do, because God knows all things (1 John 3:20). Instead, it is for the strengthening and purification of the faith of God's people so they might learn and grow through the test. Furthermore, God speaks to people in discovery terms so they might hear and know that God "now will use them" according to His purpose. Testing verses are also related to God's anthropomorphic expression where God speaks in human terms in human ways as He reveals Himself to and through people.
Numbers 14:11, "How long will this people spurn Me?"	December 09, 2008 3 min read "And the Lord said to Moses, "How long will this people spurn Me? And how long will they not believe in Me, despite all the signs which I have performed in their midst?" (Num. 14:11). Some open theists say that God's question to Moses was an admission by God that He did not know how long the Israelites would be rebellious, but this is not necessarily so. The statement is not a statement of God's ignorance. It was a necessary statement for the benefit of Moses. Think about it. Would it have been appropriate for God to say to Moses, "They will not believe me for 3 months, 17 days, 5 hours, and 14 minutes? After that, they will believe. So Moses, I would like you to relax, do nothing, and I'll take care of it." Nope, instead of God proclaiming what He knew, He worked in our time frame and said what Moses expected to hear (God's expression of dismay at them), which is proper considering their lack of belief. Sure, God can take care of them by doing a miracle or something, but sometimes He takes care of people's doubts by using other people to pray and intercede, to warn others, etc. Apparently, this is what God wants to be done since God uses people to a...
Open theism and libertarian free will	December 08, 2008 9 min read Open Theism states that God has granted to people free will and that in order for this free will to remain free, God cannot know ahead of time what the choices of people will be. They reason that if God knew a future choice of a person, then that person would not be truly free to choose anything different when the time comes to make that choice. Therefore, they say, if God knows the future free will choices of people, then it means that free will doesn't really exist. Furthermore, they hold to a view of free will known as libertarian free will. This is the position that a person is equally able to make choices between options independent of pressures or constraints from external or internal causes. In other words, the person is able to equally choose between any set of options. By contrast, compatibilist free will holds that a person can choose only that which is consistent with his nature and that there are constraints and influences upon his ability to choose. In libertarian free will, a sinner is equally able to choose God or reject God regardless of his sinful condition. In compatibilist free will, a sinner can only choose to do that which is con...

Open Theism verses listed by topic	December 09, 2008 1 min read Following is a list, by category, of verses used by Open Theists to support their position that God does not know all things. Clicking on the links will take you to the pages addressing each verse:
Open Theism: Category of verses listed by explanation	December 08, 2008 5 min read This is a list of different verses used by open theists, categorized by type of explanation; some of the verses appear in multiple categories:
Questions for or open theists	December 09, 2008 3 min read Open theism teaches that God does not know the future either because He chooses to, or because the future is unknowable. Following are questions to ask open theists:
Questions for or open theists, responses, and answers.	December 09, 2008 8 min read The following is a reprint of my original paper (in black text), with an open theists response (in brown text), and my answer to his response (in green text):
Response to Bob Enyart's article "God is NOT Outside of Time Says Matt Slick"	March 24, 2019 7 min read On Dec. 1, 2017, I debated Mr. Will Duffy on open theism. The debate occurred in the Denver, Colorado area. The topic of the debate was "Is Open Theism a Proper Representation of the God of Scripture?" No, it is not. Nevertheless, I recently discovered an article written by Bob Enyart that someone posted on a Facebook page that I was on. I forgot which one. I first saw it on 3/22/2019. I perused the article and quickly found this. "Matt Slick made a major turnaround in his Calvinism and a huge concession to open theism. As a popular theologian, he now rejects the position he has had held for decades, namely, the settled-view belief that God exists outside of time." jesuspreacher.com/god-is-not-outside-of-time-says-matt-slick/ Well, not exactly.
The plain reading of scripture	December 09, 2008 5 min read Open theists claim that the best way to read the Bible is to read it for its plain meaning whenever possible. This is a good presupposition, but it cannot always be done. There are scriptures that do not allow for a plain reading and we must interpret them in light of other verses. The open theist agrees with this. But, because the open theist teaches that God does not know all things in the future and/or the future is not knowable, then when they approach scriptures where God relents, repents, or tests people, they then state that the best way to read these scriptures is plainly and clearly. Thus, they find support for the idea that God is learning, making mistakes, and taking risks. But the problem is with their presupposition and its imposition upon various texts without regard to other texts that contradict their presupposition. For example... The Bible says in 1 John 3:20 "...for God is greater than our heart, and knows all things." Also in 1 Sam. 15:29 the Bible says, "Also the Glory of Israel will not lie or change His mind; for He is not a man that He should change His mind." Of course, the plain meaning of these texts is obvious; we see that Go...
Things you might hear the God of Open Theism say	December 09, 2008 2 min read The following list of statements is not meant to be offensive to the Open Theist. They are meant to be both humorous and illustrative. Open Theism teaches that God does not know future events, that He can be surprised by them, that He can make mistakes, and that He learns what will happen as people make choices. Therefore, what kinds of things might we hear the God of Open Theism say? This is lighthearted, and I mean no mockery nor insult; but this is a way of illustrating the point that the view of God in open theism means God does not know all of the future and can even make mistakes - otherwise, according to openness, God wouldn't have any regrets. If we assumed that the god of open theism was true, would it bring you comfort to know that God learns, that God doesn't know the future exhaustively, and that He has to wait to find out what people will do? How would that affect your prayers to Him? Would it give you confidence in God? After all, what if something happens that surprises God and He is unable to answer your prayer? If God is hoping for the best, reacting to people, and working around them to make things happen, then can you really count ...
What are the basic tenets of open theism?	December 09, 2008 2 min read Following are the basic tenets of Open Theism; it is with these presuppositions that open theists approach the Bible and interpret it: As you can see, these core tenets of Open Theism present a view of God contrary to classical and historic Christianity which sees God as sovereign, all-knowing, and unchanging.
What is Open Theism?	December 09, 2008 5 min read Open Theism, also called openness and the open view, is a theological position dealing with human free will and its relationship to God and the nature of the future. It is the teaching that God has granted to humanity free will and that in order for the free will to be truly free, the future free will choices of individuals cannot be known ahead of time by God. They hold that if God knows what we are going to choose, then how can we be truly free when it is time to make those choices -

since a counter choice cannot then be made by us, because it is already "known" what we are going to do. In other words, we would not actually be able to make a contrary choice to what God "knows" we will choose thus implying that we would not then be free. In Open Theism, the future is either knowable or not knowable. For the open theists who hold that the future is knowable by God, they maintain that God voluntarily limits His knowledge of free will choices so that they can remain truly free. Other open theists maintain that the future, being nonexistent, is not knowable, even by God. Gregory Boyd, a well-known advocate of Open Theism says, "Much of it [the future], ...

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Philadelphia Church of God

<https://carm.org/philadelphia-church-of-god> Author: CARM Date: 2020-10-13T18:01:05-06:00 1 min read

Philadelphia Church of God history

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- [The Philadelphia Church of God: A Christian Analysis](#)

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- [The Philadelphia Church of God: A Christian Analysis](#)

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Rastafari

<https://carm.org/rastafari> Author: CARM Date: 2020-10-13T18:02:54-06:00 1 min read

Explore Christian Apologetics, theology, and more. This page is a place holder for a link to the Rastafari page, examining their beliefs.

Index / linked topics on CARM

- [What is Rastafari?](#)

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- [What is Rastafari?](#)

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Scientology

<https://carm.org/scientology> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2020-10-13T18:04:36-06:00 4 min read

Founder: L. Ron Hubbard, born March 13, 1911, and died January 24, 1986. He began studying the mind in 1923.

Headquarters: Los Angeles

Origins: The first Scientology church was formed in Los Angeles in 1954.

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Westboro Baptist Church

<https://carm.org/westboro-baptist-church> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2010-04-13T09:10:28-06:00
8 min read

Founder: Fred Phelps (b. 1929) became pastor of Westboro Baptist church in 1955. Ordained in the Southern Baptist denomination in 1947, married to Margie Phelps. (godhatesfags.com/written/wbcinfo/phelpsbio.html) Headquarters: Topeka, KS. Membership: Origins: The Westboro Church was founded in 1955 by Fred Phelps Practices: Picketing various funerals of homosexuals, soldiers, and others who have been killed in various ways, citing God as the reason they were killed because God hates them.

Teachings: Jesus only died for his sheep (godhatesfags.com/faq.html) They hold to the five points of Calvinism. (We must be careful here not to associate Calvinism with Westboro Baptist Church's behavior. Many Calvinists stand against what they are doing.)

dead and missing are 20,000 Swedes and over 3,000 Americans? Filthy Swedes went to Thailand - world epicenter of child sex traffic - to rape and sodomize little Thai boys and girls. 20,000 dead Swedes is to Sweden's population of 9 million as 650,000 would be to America's 290 million population. We sincerely hope and pray that all 20,000 Swedes are dead, their bodies bloated on the ground or in mass graves or floating at sea feeding sharks and fishes or in the bellies of thousands of crocodiles washed ashore by tsunamis. These filthy, faggot Swedes have a satanic, draconian law criminalizing Gospel preaching, under which they prosecuted, convicted and sentenced Pastor Ake Green to jail - thereby incurring God's irreversible wrath: "He suffered no man to do them wrong; yea, he reprov'd kings for their sakes; Saying, Touch not mine anointed, and do my prophets no harm." Psa. 105:14,15. America, who is awash in diseased fag feces & semen, and is an apostate land of the sodomite damned. Let us pray that God will send a massive Tsunami to totally devastate the North American continent with 1000-foot walls of water doing 500 mph - even as islands in southern Asia have recently been laid waste, with but a small remnant surviving. And you wonder if this is the wrath of God?"

(godhatesfags.com/faq.html) First of all, read this transcript from Scarborough Country and this transcript from Hannity And Colmes that explain why. Secondly, here are some axiomatic matters of fact: These turkeys are not heroes. They are lazy, incompetent idiots looking for jobs because they're not qualified for honest work. They were raised on a steady diet of fag propaganda in the home, on TV, in church, in school, in mass media - everywhere - the two-pronged lie: 1) It's OK to be gay; and, 2) Anyone saying otherwise, like WBC, is a hater who must be vilified, demonized, marginalized into silence.

Therefore, with full knowledge of what they were doing, they voluntarily joined a fag-infested army to fight for a fag-run country now utterly and finally forsaken by God who Himself is fighting against that country" "Thank God! God has cursed this nation with total bible ignorance, blind deaf eyes, deaf ears and hard hearts!" (blogs.sparenote.com/index.php?blog=1) "Thank God 71 Pakistani civilians killed in military air strike!" (blogs.sparenote.com/index.php?blog=1) "Thank God for dead soldiers!" (blogs.sparenote.com/index.php?blog=1)

Publications: westborobaptistchurch.com, godhatesfags.com. "...the World's Greatest Publishing Company flies under the banner of Westboro Baptist Church." (godhatesfags.com/written/wbcinfo/publishingcompany.html). Blog at

blogs.sparenot.com/index.php?blog=1. Signs used for picketing include "GOD HATES FAGS, FAGS HATE GOD, AIDS CURES FAGS, THANK GOD FOR AIDS, FAGS BURN IN HELL, GOD IS NOT MOCKED, FAGS ARE NATURE FREAKS, GOD GAVE FAGS UP, NO SPECIAL LAWS FOR FAGS, FAGS DOOM NATIONS, THANK GOD FOR DEAD SOLDIERS, FAG TROOPS, GOD BLEW UP THE TROOPS, GOD HATES AMERICA, AMERICA IS DOOMED, THE WORLD IS DOOMED" (godhatesfags.com/wbcinfo/aboutwbc.html)

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- First of all, read this transcript from Scarborough Country and this transcript from Hannity And Colmes that explain why. Secondly, here are some axiomatic matters of fact: These turkeys are not heroes. They are lazy, incompetent idiots looking for jobs because they're not qualified for honest work. They were raised on a steady diet of fag propaganda in the home, on TV, in church, in school, in mass media - everywhere - the two-pronged lie: 1) It's OK to be gay; and, 2) Anyone saying otherwise, like WBC, is a hater who must be vilified, demonized, marginalized into silence. Therefore, with full knowledge of what they were doing, they voluntarily joined a fag-infested army to fight for a fag-run country now utterly and finally forsaken by God who Himself is fighting against that country"
- "Thank God! God has cursed this nation with total bible ignorance, blind deaf eyes, deaf ears and hard hearts!" (blogs.sparenot.com/index.php?blog=1)
- "Thank God 71 Pakistani civilians killed in military air strike!" (blogs.sparenot.com/index.php?blog=1)
- "Thank God for dead soldiers!" (blogs.sparenot.com/index.php?blog=1)

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About the Occult

<https://carm.org/about-occult> Author: CARM Date: 2020-06-24T17:06:55-06:00 1 min read

Answers to various questions about the occult, the paranormal, horoscopes, etc., from a Christian and biblical perspective

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SECTION B - DISCIPLESHIP AND BIBLICAL SLAVERY

What is the biblical view of discipleship?

<https://carm.org/what-is-the-biblical-view-of-discipleship> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2015-08-04T22:31:56-06:00 10 min read

Discipleship is a mandatory requirement for being a Christian. Some follow Christ more devotedly than others, but all Christians are called to be disciples and disciple-makers. The Biblical view of discipleship is one of following Jesus as revealed in the Bible, self-denial, sacrifice, love, patience, and so much more.

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What is the cost of discipleship?

<https://carm.org/what-is-the-cost-of-discipleship> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2015-08-04T22:36:43-06:00 4 min read

The following outline is my notes that I used when speaking at a conference on discipleship and the cost of discipleship. Please feel free to use them and modify them. Discipleship is an important aspect of the Christian church as well as the Christian believer.

The cost of discipleship means giving up on your own desires as you submit them to the will of God through the person of Jesus. It means that you do what is right in his eyes even if it costs you here on earth. Furthermore, every Christian should count the cost of what it means to be a disciple and not just a so-called Christian that gets lip-service to the Christian faith.

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You may buy slaves?

<https://carm.org/you-may-buy-slaves> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2008-11-28T15:41:16-07:00 2 min read

Does the Bible say that it is okay for us to buy slaves? Does it encourage a slave trade? Critics of Christianity claim so, often pointing to passages like Leviticus 25:44. Is this really what the verse is saying? Let's take a look:

Leviticus 25:44, "As for your male and female slaves whom you may have - you may acquire male and female slaves from the pagan nations that are around you."

In the fallen world that mankind had created, slavery was a reality. God permitted its existence and worked within its system. Slaves were more domestic servants than oppressed field workers. Slaves could be the captives of war (Num. 31:25-47), subjects of debt to be worked off (2 Kings 4:1), born into slavery (Gen. 17:12-13), or entered into voluntarily (Exodus 21:5-6). In the Ancient Near East, some slaves were able to own other slaves and even conduct business. In Exodus 21:2, a slave was required to be set free after six years of service. Though slavery rightly carries a very negative connotation here in America, the word implies a very different institution in ancient Israel than what we had here in the first 100 years of our nation's existence. Thus, we have to consider what it meant to "buy slaves" at that time and also how God accommodated fallen realities for a time during the progression of redemptive history.

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A slave is property?

<https://carm.org/a-slave-is-property> Author: Matt Slick Date: 2008-11-28T15:31:28-07:00 3 min read

Slavery in the Bible was different than in modern times. The issue of property deals with what is produced, not that the person was actual property. We know this because property was to be returned to the owner. But, the Bible prohibited the extradition of slaves and granted them asylum (Deut. 23:16-17). Therefore, they were not property in the sense of chattel slavery.

"And if a man strikes his male or female slave with a rod and he dies at his hand, he shall be punished. 21 If, however, he survives a day or two, no vengeance shall be taken; for he is his property," (Exodus 21:20-21).

What are we to make of the disciplinary statement of Scripture regarding a slave?

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SECTION C - BONUS: MIDIANITES (NUMBERS 31:17-18)

Why were only the virgins left alive among the Midianites?

<https://carm.org/why-were-only-the-virgins-left-alive-among-the-midianites-in-numbers-3117-18>

Author: Matt Slick Date: 2008-11-28T16:01:04-07:00 3 min read

The Midianite virgins were not killed in Numbers 31:17-18 because they did not participate in the idolatrous sin of Baal at Peor. They were not kept for sexual exploitation, but were to be integrated into Israeli households. Let's take a look.

Num. 31:17-18, "Now therefore, kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman who has known man intimately. 18 But all the girls who have not known a man intimately, spare for yourselves."

The Midianites were descended from Abraham and Keturah (Gen. 25:1). They inhabited the land of Moab and were apparently involved in seducing Israel into going after false gods. Because the Israelites fell into idolatry this way, God told Moses to order the deaths of all who had bowed to the false gods in that land.

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Living Word Map - Part 6. Rebuild: [scripts/build-carm-part6-study-pdf.ps1](#)